



Use VirtualDub To Split Movie Files

Now, fit high-quality DVD rips on CDs!

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What do you do when you want to resize or cut a large movie file—say an AVI file—into two or more parts, so that they can be written onto CDs? DVD ripping tools have inbuilt splitters, but one often ends up with problems such as sound lag and low volume in the ripped output file. The ideal method would be to let the DVD ripping tool rip the entire DVD movie to a single AVI file, and then use VirtualDub, a tool for splitting such files into smaller chunks - and if need be, correct the volume and sound lag problems.

VirtualDub is freeware licensed under the GNU General Public License. You can download it from <http://sourceforge.net/projects/virtualdub>.

Choose the package named VirtualDub-1.6.11.zip (i386 type) for a computer running a Win32 OS. Unzip the package to a folder with preferably the same name. Just locate the file named VirtualDub.exe and run it. The process does not involve installation; just accept the GNU license, and the main window of VirtualDub pops up.

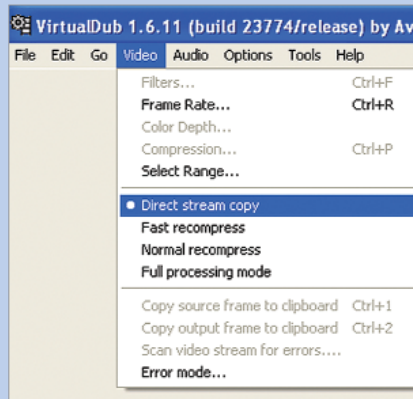
You can also split files of other formats using VirtualDub. If you're splitting a DivX file, note that problems have been reported with splitting older versions of DivX-encoded video (DivX version 4.02), so it is advisable to upgrade to a newer version of the codec before proceeding with VirtualDub.

1 Open The Video File

Select **File > Open Video File**, and choose the AVI video file you want to split. Click 'Open'. You'll see the movie file opened with two previews, and under it will be a timeline with a slider showing the length of the movie. The left window is the source file and the right one is a preview of the same frame of the output file. Both will be the same until you tell it to make a change."

2 Adjust Audio/Video Settings

The most important point to remember is that we're not encoding a file, so go to **Video > Direct Stream Copy**. Failing this, VirtualDub will re-encode the movie to its default format.



Ensure that you select 'Direct stream copy' in video menu

The default audio settings are preferred, but if the original ripped file is lacking in audio volume, you can increase the recorded volume by choosing 'Full processing mode' from the 'Audio' menu. This enables more audio settings. Now go back to the 'Audio' menu and choose 'Volume...', enable 'Adjust volume of audio channels', and increase or decrease the volume bar as per your judgement.

If you leave the audio settings here, you'll get a rather large output file, since the audio will be in PCM format (WAV). So, we need to do a step or two more. Go to 'Compression' in the 'Audio' menu and choose 'LameMP3'. A set of formats appears on the right. Choose '44100 Hz, 256Kbps, CBR stereo' and then click 'OK'. (If this option is not available, go to 'Conversion' under the 'Audio' menu and enable 16-bit audio.)

3 Split The Movie File

The timeline has a slider that you can move along the length of the movie. While moving the slider, note that the frame count just under the timeline shows the

frame number and the elapsed time. Move the slider to the last frame, note the total number of frames, and divide it by two if you think it will result in appropriate split file sizes.



The selected length of the movie turns blue indicating part

Now move the slider back to the first frame and press [Home]. This will create a starting point. Keeping [Shift] pressed, move the slider to a frame number that is close to half the total number of frames. At this point, press [End]; the selected time length turns blue.

Click **File > Save as AVI**, and provide a file name such as "movie_name_part 1.avi". The progress indicator dialog box appears, displaying the progress, projected file size, and other related information.

For the second part of the movie, press [Home] to set the last frame of part 1 as the first frame of part 2. Drag the slider to the last frame of the movie (remember to hold down [Shift]) and hit [End] to select the second part of the movie. Follow the same file-saving procedure to save the second half. Remember, if the movie is very long, you might even want to split the file into three or more parts - which you can easily do using the above procedure.

VirtualDub can also be used for other audio/video editing processes such as changing a movie from portrait to landscape view and vice-versa, which comes in very handy for videos shot using a mobile phone. ☐

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